

17.0 MOTOR VEHICLE OPERATION

Policy:

Vehicles are to be operated in a safe manner consistent with local, state and federal laws. All accidents must be reported promptly according to procedures outlined below. The use of vehicles is limited to necessary Company business.

Personnel permitted to drive vehicles (e.g. Company automobiles, delivery vehicles, trucks, forklifts, tractors, loaders, back hoes, bobcats, mowers, etc.) must demonstrate the knowledge and ability to operate the equipment safely to the satisfaction of a qualified examiner.

Responsibilities:

a. Driver's Supervisor

1. Ensures that employees under his/her supervision who drive vehicles possess a valid state driver's license.
2. Ensures that vehicles are used only for official Company business and carries only Company employees who are authorized passengers.
3. Ensures all operators of powered industrial trucks are properly trained in the operation of the vehicles.
4. Ensures all vehicle drivers have the necessary medical examinations to ensure that the driver is physically qualified to operate the equipment.
5. Regularly inspects vehicles and vehicle systems.

b. Employee

1. Carries the required, valid state driver's license
2. Inspects daily the vehicle before it is used. Items to be checked should include the forks, batteries, wheels, cables, lights, horns, back-up alarm, mirrors, steering, brakes, tires and controls.
3. Reports any defects or malfunctions to the supervisor immediately. Does not use a malfunctioning vehicle if the defect impairs the safe operation or use of the vehicle.
4. Operates equipment safely and in accordance to operating instructions.
5. Wears appropriate protective equipment at all times.

c. Safety and Health Manager

1. Maintains with the Supervisor, records of employee qualification tests.
2. Assists, when necessary, in selection and designation of jobs which require powered industrial trucks.
3. Periodically and routinely inspects vehicles and vehicle operations.
4. Coordinates with the supervisor, training programs for use and operation of the vehicles.

General Requirement:

- a. The examiner will administer a driving test to each prospective operator.
- b. The operator is required to:
 1. Point to and explain the following controls: lift, tilt, forward and reverse gears.
 2. Perform all driving and loading/unloading maneuvers deemed necessary by the examining official.

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c. Upon satisfactory completion of the test procedures, a permit card shall be signed by the examiner and motor vehicle licensing official. The permit shall be valid as long as health requirements and safe operating techniques are met.

Operating Rules and Practices:

- a. Safeguard pedestrians at all times. Do not drive a truck up to anyone standing in front of a stationary or fixed object (e.g., a bench or parked vehicle).
- b. Do not allow anyone to stand or pass under the elevated portion of any truck or lift.
- c. Unauthorized personnel shall not be permitted to ride on or operate powered industrial trucks. d. Never allow anyone to ride the forks, while the vehicle is in motion, or to lift them to a higher level except with a personnel platform.
- e. Do not put arms or legs between the uprights of the mast or outside the running lines of the truck.
- f. When leaving a powered industrial truck unattended, lift platform shall be fully lowered, controls shall be neutralized, power shut off, brakes set, key or connector plug removed. Block wheels if truck is parked on an incline.
- g. When you park the machine, lower the forks so they are flat on the ground. h. Maintain a safe distance from edge or ramps or platforms.
- i. Be sure of sufficient head room under overhead installations, lights, pipes, sprinkler systems, etc.
- j. Use an overhead guard as protection against falling objects.
- k. Use a load backrest extension whenever necessary to minimize the possibility of the load or part of it falling rearward.
- l. Report to supervisor all accidents involving personnel, building structures, and equipment. m. Obey all safety signs and markers.
- m. Never exceed trucks' rated capacity.
- n. Never travel with load above five feet.

Use of Powered Mowers, Tractors, etc.

- a. Operation is limited to qualified operators approved for use of specific equipment. Equipment may also be used by supervised individuals who are training for certification.
- b. Equipment operators must wear approved safety shoes, and, as appropriate, eye and hearing protection.

Motor Vehicle Accident:

In cases of accident:

1. Stop immediately.
2. Take steps to prevent another accident at the scene.
3. Call a doctor or ambulance, if necessary.
4. Notify police.
5. DO NOT sign any paper or make any statement as to who was at fault (except to your supervisor or to a Federal Government investigator).

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6. Obtain the name and address of each witness.
7. Provide your name, address, place of employment, name of your supervisor, and upon request, show your operator's permit.
8. Make notes of the following:
 - a. Registration information for other vehicle(s) (owner's name, tag number and state, serial number, and vehicle description).
 - b. Information on other driver (name, address, operator's permit number, and expiration date).
 - c. Name and address of each person involved and extent of injury, if any.
 - c. Name and address of company insuring other vehicle(s).
 - d. General information such as location, time, measurements, weather, damage, etc.
9. As soon as possible, notify your supervisor and, if driving an interagency motor pool vehicle, the manager of the pool which issued the vehicle.
10. If the vehicle is unsafe to operate, have it towed to the nearest garage or service station.
11. If you are injured, notify the Safety and Health Manager.
12. Submit all reports and data to your supervisor within one working day.
13. If you are injured have the police notify your supervisor who will assume your responsibilities for reporting the accident.

100 Hour Maintenance Inspection:

The following items must be checked on a 100 hour maintenance inspection schedule by a qualified mechanic.

Steering and horn – check free play – ease of handling horn operation. Brakes – check brake power.

Tires – remove all foreign matter from tires.

Hoist cylinder – check for leaks and wear – clean off. Tilt cylinder – check for leaks and wear – clean off. Hydraulic oil – check dipstick – add oil, if necessary. Forks – check for cracked or bent forks.

Battery – check water level.

Acceleration control – check speed – time delay- general operation. Wires and terminals – check and tighten.

Lubricate – as specified on lubrication chart. Hoist motor – check brush wear.

Drive motor – check brush wear.

Controller – check contact tips – switches.